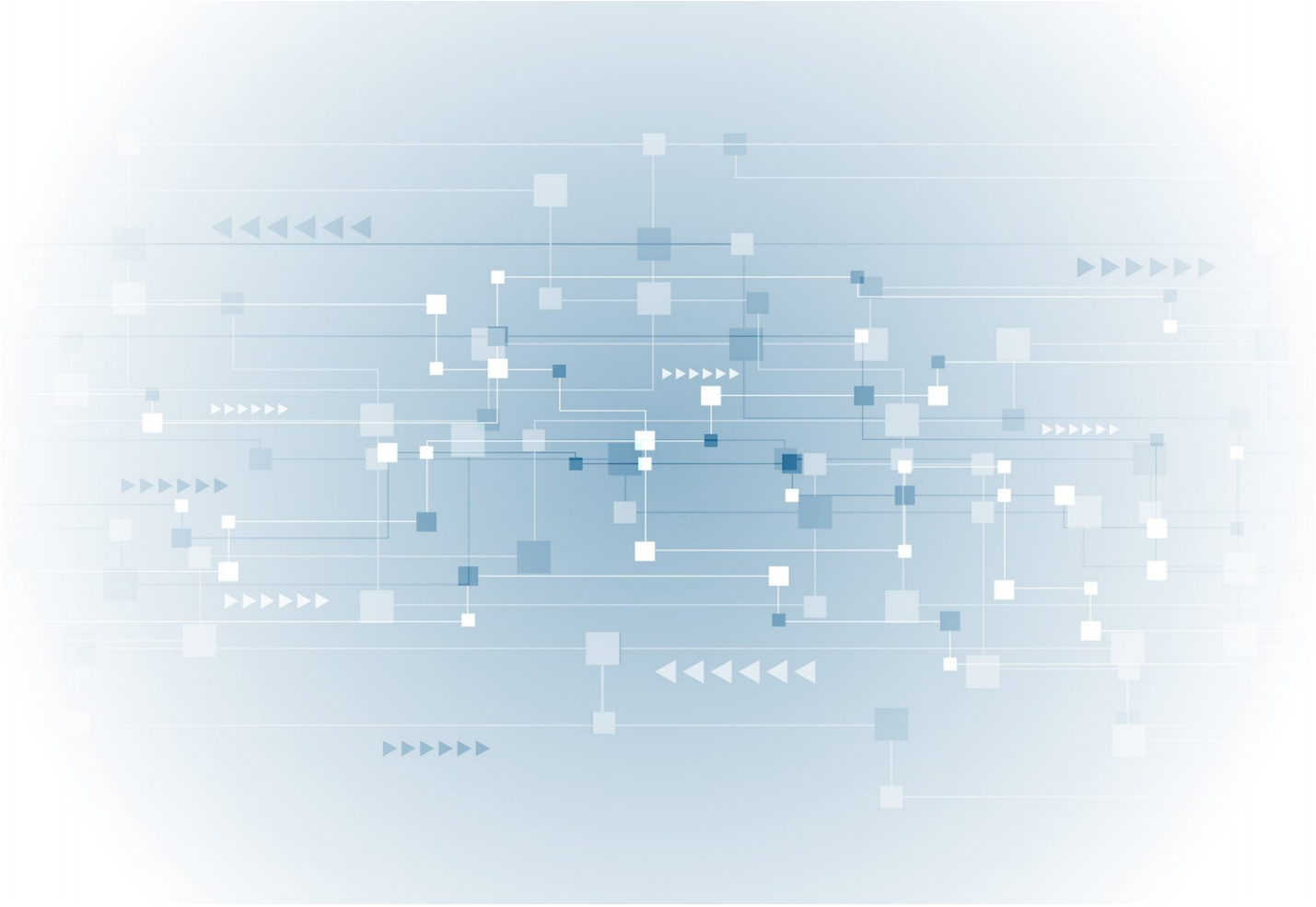
Ravensbourne University London

Project Title	
Deadline	Portfolio or dissertation: Friday, 10th April 2026, by 17.00 PM BST via Canvas Presentation: In person slots, Week commencing TBC
Submission Method	Portfolio or dissertation: Digitally via Canvas Presentation: In person at Ravensbourne
Project Staff	Dr Noman Sultan

Module Title	**Final Project**	**Level / Semester**	L7 Semester 03
Module Code	MCS 22707	**Credit / Weighting**	60
Module Leader	Dr Noman Sultan	**Date of Issue**	Jan 2026

Final Year Project



Ravensbourne University London

Project Brief

The Final Project in the MSc computer Science course is the culmination of the student's studies and will form a framework for the central ideas and concepts developed throughout the entire programme at Ravensbourne. Through the realisation of the advanced final project, the student will demonstrate evidence of advanced conceptual, theoretical and technical capability over an extended period of self-directed study.

You should draw upon and consider all the outcomes of your work developed throughout your whole master's degree to give an overview of ideation to resolution. Consideration should be given to the relationship between the theoretical discourses pursued within your studies and the practical manifestation of your knowledge of Computer Science. This is an advanced project regarded as an exercise in the Design, Implementation, Interpretation and presentation of programming, data analysis, creative thinking, testing related directly to your subject discipline and should support either further studies or your professional trajectory. As such, the format of the final submission is flexible to allow you to present your individual project in a context appropriate to your subject of interest within the field of Computer Science and your personal circumstances.

The main outcome of the Dissertation Project Module is a written paper (accompanied by an artifact where appropriate). Although the research process within the project may require the creation of product or services (i.e software and other systems to enable the verification of the project goals, the submission of such product or service would be a requirement for the assessment of this module

At the end you will communicate your research, findings and conclusions through one of the below formats:

1) **A portfolio of work: which includes a final Report or Portfolio of 7,000 words +/- 10%, on a real-world solution in the practice of computer science**

At the postgraduate level in Computer Science, a portfolio refers to a structured collection of technical and reflective materials that document, support, and explain the research and development process support your final project. A portfolio-based research project focused where your research process and outcomes are documented through a collection of artifacts, not just in a single, final dissertation. It emphasises process as much as product, often integrating code, design iterations, testing logs, reflections, and other multimedia or technical artifacts.

Your computer science projects involve complex, iterative problem-solving processes that extend far beyond what is represented in the final dissertation or codebase. While these final outputs demonstrate the result of the project, they often do not capture the decisions, challenges, and refinements that were made throughout the development and research lifecycle.

A well-crafted portfolio provides a platform to document and showcase the thought process, technical reasoning, and adaptability that underpin the work. These are not only core academic skills but also reflect the professional competencies expected in real-world AI, software engineering, data science, and research in emerging

technologies.

For practitioner-based research, the portfolio plays an especially critical role. It presents evidence of the design trials, prototyping phases, debugging iterations, and performance testing that may not be fully visible in the final product. In doing so, the portfolio ensures a more transparent and comprehensive assessment of the effort, learning, and creativity involved. Ultimately, the portfolio bridges the gap between process and product, offering a holistic view of the project that supports fair and meaningful evaluation.

A portfolio may contain (but is not limited to):

- Code samples or Git logs
- Technical designs (e.g., UML diagrams, wireframes)
- Experiment documentation
- Reflective commentary on decisions and challenges
- Evaluation metrics and records of iterations

AND

- 15-minute Presentation (10-minute presentation and 5-minute Q&A)

OR

2) **A dissertation: an in-depth study of 7,000 words +/- 10%, including an analysis of a computer science related topic**

As part of your MSc Computer Science dissertation module, you have the option to undertake a 'Dissertation Based Research Project'. This format is traditional and outcome-focused, designed to assess your ability to conduct formal academic research and present it in a structured, coherent manner. A dissertation-based research project where your main output is a written dissertation, a formal document that presents your problem statement, research questions, methodology, results, and conclusions.

While your technical implementation (e.g., software, models, simulations) is also important, it is submitted as a supporting code repository, not as the primary focus. This approach places less emphasis on documenting the process (like iterative development or design reflection), and more on the final research outcomes and academic rigour.

A dissertation may contain (but not limited to)

- Abstract and Introduction
- Literature Review
- Methodology and Research Design
- System or Experimental Setup
- Results and Evaluation
- Analysis, Discussion, and Conclusion

Code Repository (e.g., GitHub), which may contain but is not limited to:

- Clearly organised and well-commented code
- Properly linked and referenced within your dissertation
- Sufficient documentation to allow others to reproduce key results or system functionality

AND :

- 15-minute Presentation (10-minute presentation and 5-minute Q&A)

FUTHER GUIDANCE

Project Supervision

Managing the relationship with your supervisor is essential for a successful MSc Computer Science dissertation. As this project is an individual, self-directed learning experience, it is your responsibility as the student to actively initiate contact, schedule meetings, and engage with your supervisor throughout the project.

Come prepared with progress updates, clear questions, or areas where feedback is needed. Be receptive to constructive criticism and demonstrate how you have acted on advice. Additionally, it is vital to understand and follow the university's **ethical regulations**, especially if your project involves human participants, sensitive data, or emerging technologies. You must discuss any potential ethical concerns with your supervisor and seek formal ethical approval where required.

A well-managed, proactive relationship grounded in regular communication, mutual respect, and ethical responsibility will support both your academic development and the successful completion of your project.

AI Declaration Form

Due to university regulations on the use of Artificial Intelligence, it is mandatory to submit an **AI Declaration Form**. You must clearly disclose which generative AI tools you have used, as well as how and why these tools were used in your FYP dissertation or portfolio work.

Additional Support

In addition, to working with your supervisor, you are strongly encouraged to make full use of the face-to-face support sessions provided during scheduled classes. These sessions are designed to offer structured guidance, peer and formative feedback, and practical insights to help keep your learning and project development on track. Attending regularly allows you to raise questions, clarify expectations, share challenges, and benefit from the experiences of others.

These sessions also reinforce key academic and technical skills, ensuring that you stay aligned with project milestones and assessment criteria. Active participation demonstrates your commitment to the independent learning process and significantly increases your chances of producing a successful dissertation.

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Essential Reading List from the module specification – Harvard referenced

Essential Reading List

Dawson, C (2015). Projects in Computing and Information Systems: A Student's Guide. 3rd ed. UK: Pearson Education.

Dawson, C (2019). Introduction to Research Methods: A Practical Guide for Anyone Undertaking a Research Project. 5th ed. London: Robinson.

Recommended Reading List

Guay, M., Schreiber, D. and Briones, S. (2016). The Ultimate Guide to Project Management:

Learn everything you need to successfully manage projects and get them done. Free Kindle Edition. US: Zapier Inc.

Pinto, J.K. (2015). Project Management: Achieving Competitive Advantage. 4th Ed. Pearson.

Lock, D. (2013). Project Management. 8th Ed. UK: Routledge

Biggam John 2021 Succeeding With Your Master's Dissertation: A Step-by-Step Handbook (UK

Higher Education OUP Humanities & Social Sciences Study Skills)

Hammond, Michael (July 2022) Writing a Postgraduate Thesis or Dissertation: Tools for Success (Routledge study skills)

Wallace and Wray 2021 - Critical Reading and Writing for Postgraduates (Student Success)

Resources required

Computer/Laptop with internet connection

Assessment andtutor feedback date	Student will receive feedback and assessment in accordance with deadlines subject to the registry timetable. Students who miss the deadline or fail this project may be required to complete a retrieval project which demonstrates that the learning outcomes have been achieved. Students should be aware that retrieval submissions are capped at a bare pass grade, unless the extenuating circumstances panel uphold an evidenced application. The deadline for retrieval submissions will be determined at an Assessment Board. The deadline for retrieval submissions will be determined at an Assessment Board.
Academic Misconduct	As specified in our General Academic Regulations, Academic Misconduct (e.g., plagiarism, inappropriate use of AI applications and tools, collusion, fabrication of information, contract cheating etc) will be dealt with formally following our procedure for Academic Misconduct. This means for example, close similarity between students' assessments, suspected use of AI, or third-party completion of assessed work and assessments that are not referenced appropriately are likely to lead to an investigation. The penalty for academic misconduct is a fail grade with an additional penalty applied according to the gravity of the case. If you have any doubts about how to avoid plagiarism, inappropriate use of AI or how group work assessments are submitted to recognise individuals' work and contribution, please discuss this with the module tutor or Course Leader. When you submit your assessments, you will be asked to complete/sign a declaration that it is your own work.
Late submissions	You can submit work up to 24 hours after the module deadline. This work will be capped as a pass grade unless you have a 5-day approved extension or other approved Extenuating Circumstances (ECs). Please see the Academic Regulations below for further details.
Academic Regulations 25/26	To pass this module, you should aim to submission work before the deadline shown within this brief. However, it you fail to submit the work you will be offered 2 further retrieval opportunities. The grade for both retrieval opportunities will be capped unless you have approved Extenuating Circumstances. You will be notified of a new deadline date for the retrieval opportunities via a 'Retrieval Module brief'. How to apply for a 5-day extension? You can apply for a 5-day extension for any module(s) during the year. This must be done before the submission deadline for each module. Click here to find 5-day extension application How to apply for Extenuating Circumstances? You can apply for Extenuating Circumstances before the deadline or within 5 days of the deadline: Click here to find EC application

	Note: You can apply for Extenuating Circumstances for any module, except where the assessment is 'ungraded' and marked as Pass/Fail' only. **For further information please use this link to access General Academic Regulations**
Other requirements for submission	**N/A**

Module learning outcomes	
LO_01	Critically evaluate and synthesise existing key data and theoretical knowledge using a wide range of research methodologies in the development of the final project
LO_02	Engage in testing and experimentation of data and analysis alongside contextual debates relating to the chosen subject to develop best practice in computer Science to support your final project
LO_03	Present a fully resolved final computer science project, demonstrating specialist technical and practical knowledge
LO_04	Be self-directed in liaising with your supervisor and peers in planning and implementing a computer science project to a coherent professional level
LO_05	Critically evaluate and analyse the principles of computer science; their application and impact on creating and capturing value for business
LO_06	Critically analyse and test the impact of emerging issues of computer science activities and propose innovative and creative solutions to these issues

Assessment Criteria	
AC_01	**Explore:** Research and Analysis Plan and manage a significant individual project, including detailed considerations of resources, timetabling and professional issues
AC_02	**Create:** Experimentation Undertake specialised research in the main field of study building on existing research and knowledge.
AC_03	**Create:** Technical Competence Build a substantial system from design to documentation, or carry out a substantial research project from methodology to conclusion
AC_04	**Communication**: Presentation Present proposals for future studies based on the conducted study
AC_05	**Create:** Experimentation Present your work orally, with appropriate uses of audio-visual aids and interactive demonstrations, and respond to questions effectively
AC_06	**Explore**: Research and Analysis Participate in research and development work or carry out independent work in other advanced context

Assessment Methods and Tasks

Assessment tasks	Submission Method	Weighting %
15 minutes Presentation (10 minute Presentation and 5 minute Q&A)	In person at Ravensbourne University	30%
A portfolio of work: which include a final computer science Report or Portfolio of 7000 words +/-10% on a real-world solution in the practice of Computer Science. **OR** Dissertation: an in-depth study of 7000 words +/-10% including an analysis of a computer science related topic. All work submission requirements to be agreed with the Course Tutor	Digitally via Canvas	70%